

Homeschooling: for or against?

1. Complete the statements so that they are true for you.

- When I was a child my favourite thing about school was...
- The thing that I disliked about school was...
- My typical school day looked like this:...

2. Match the questions to the correct answers.

- a) Do you know any people who were **homeschooled**?
 - b) Did you spend much time with your **peers** when you went to school?
 - c) Are home schools **legal** in your country?
 - d) How could schools help children who feel **isolated** from their classmates?
 - e) Which is better: to **study at your own pace** or with your classmates?
 - f) What are some **drawbacks** of giving homework to students?
 - g) What are some problems that **conventional schools** have?
 - h) How can we use technology to make sure all students have **opportunities** to learn?
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- 1) To properly understand something, you need to do it as slowly or fast as you like.
 - 2) I am an extrovert, so I had many friends at school, and we always did fun things.
 - 3) They could organize some team-building events to help students make friends. Psychological support can help, too.
 - 4) When children come home, they should spend time with family or friends.
 - 5) No, they are not. All kids have to go to school, they can't receive education at home.
 - 6) Teachers don't give enough attention to students. Also, many schools don't have enough equipment and the buildings are quite old.
 - 7) Yes, one of my friends studied at home.
 - 8) Online learning can help students who live a long way from a school because they can attend virtual lessons without worrying about how to get to school.

3. Discuss the questions in ex. 2.

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4. Complete the US statistics with one of the two options: 'homeschooled students' or 'students from conventional schools'.

- a) In standard tests, get 15 to 30% more points than
.....
- b) 67% of graduate from university, while the number of
..... who complete higher education is 57.5%.

5. Discuss the questions.

- Are you surprised by the facts in ex. 4?
- Do they prove that homeschooling is better than conventional schooling?

6. Watch a [video](https://youtu.be/aG4B273EhyI) [https://youtu.be/aG4B273EhyI] and answer the questions.

- a) What is special about the McCullough family?
- b) How would you describe Andrew's and Kaity's school day?

7. Watch the [video](#) again. Correct the statements to make them true.

- a) All the subjects that Kaity and Andrew study are different from what students have in conventional schools.
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- b) Andrew thinks that the biggest plus of homeschooling is spending time with his family.
.....
- c) Kristi doesn't give grades to her children.
.....
- d) Kaity believes that homeschooled children are often lonely.
.....
- e) When Kaity and Andrew are older, they want to continue homeschool education.
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8. Discuss the questions.

- Kristi said that homeschooling is a great opportunity for a family to be together. Do you agree with her?
- Why might a parent decide to homeschool their child?
- Would you ever homeschool your children?
- Would you prefer to have been homeschooled? Would your life be different?

9. Choose a number from 1 to 10. You will be given a topic to talk about.

10. List the advantages and disadvantages of these unconventional education ideas.

- Unschooling. Education happens in freedom: there are no tests, assignments or educational programmes at all.
- Hiring private tutors and teachers for homeschooling.
- Online education. Taking online courses instead of going to school.
- A child studies at home some days and at a conventional school some days.